Chemical Digestion

Exam code: 0610 & 0970

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Written by: Lára Marie McIvor
Reviewed by: Lucy Kirkham
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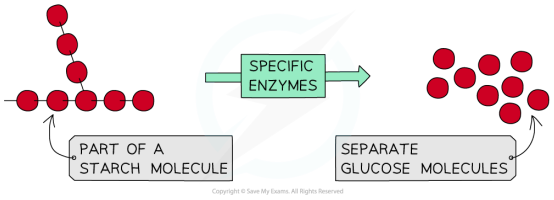
Chemical Digestion

- Chemical digestion is the **breakdown of large insoluble molecules** into **small soluble molecules**
  - E.g., starch is broken down into simple sugars using the enzyme amylase
- Chemical digestion is required because large insoluble molecules are **unable to be absorbed** through the wall of the small intestines
- Small soluble molecules produced from chemical digestion, are **easily absorbed** into the surrounding capillaries
- **Enzymes** are required for chemical digestion to take place



Chemical digestion involves the breakdown of large insoluble molecules into small soluble molecules for absorption

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